

Past, Present, Future

Tabitha is way ahead of her time
Dakota is behind his times
Just in time to meet in the middle
as Tab and Coda

It gives a whole new meaning to
“Right Person, Wrong Time”

STAGE MUSICAL OVERVIEW

Past, Present, Future is a musical adventure romance that follows Tabitha and Dakota, lonely musicians respectively from the 1st Century Middle East and 21st Century Midwest whose guitars carved from spacetime wood trap them in the 19th Century Romantic era. They form the duo “Tab and Coda” to survive the wrath of the Timeharmonic Orchestra until they can return to their home timeline, not without together becoming the right people at the wrong time. It explores bittersweet themes like mortality, an appreciation for wisdom, an everlasting search for freshness, and the value of nature in music.

WHY (THEN) NOW (LATER)?

Past, Present, Future speaks to many of our feelings of not fitting into your own era. Seeing a 1st-century woman find her soul in alternative hip-hop while a 21st-century newcomer finds peace in ancient hymns is meant to comfort the audience who feel like an outsider into seeking out musical communities. By blending ancient roots with future sounds, they prove that we can find our people and build a home, even when the timing feels completely wrong. Tabitha and Dakota are like us: they are the right people at the wrong times.

It also matters now when we are all out of sync with the world. We’re living in a hyper-digital age where algorithms dictate what we listen to and everything is moving too fast. The Timeharmonic Orchestra personifies that pressure to be perfect and efficient all the time. When Tab and Coda fight back with instruments made of wood and seeds, the musical is a gentle reminder to unplug, slow down, and remember the human soul behind the art.

CAST OF CHARACTERS

TABITHA is a lyre maker from 1st Century Galilee who is way ahead of her time and in over her head. She seeks that “new sound.” Destiny, the Timepiper of the Future, gifts her American basswood which she uses to build her oud that sends her into the future. Tab finds home in alternative hip hop. As a singer, she is a breath of fresh air to what music could be.

DAKOTA is a guitar maker from 21st Century Free Soil, Michigan who is behind the times. They honor the “oldies.” Frailty, the Timepiper of the Past, gifts them Judean palm date seeds for their guitar, which sends them back in time. Kota finds home in psalmody. As a guitarist, they are an old soul showing what music once was, never staying up to date on the mainstream.

JESSE is the father of Tabitha. **JESSICA** is the mother of Dakota.

TIMEHARMONIC ORCHESTRA

ETERNITY LINGER is the omnipotent Spacetime Bandleader. They lead the Timepipers (the chorus of fate) to run each timeline smoothly but is on the verge of killing the Conductor. They often are addressed as madam or sir based on Ling Lun, the legendary founder of music in ancient China.

FRAILITY is the Timepiper of the Past, based on the Norse Norn, Urd. They navigate darkened times as a plover with metallic calls. They are the oldest of the three immortal shapeshifters. They like messing with Reality.

REALITY is the Timepiper of the Present, based on the Norse Norn, Skuld. They trek the rough terrains of spacetime as an upland sandpiper with ethereal whistles. They are the most uptight and suck up to Eternity.

DESTINY is the Timepiper of the Future, based on the Norse Norn, Verdandi. They go with the flow of time as a spotted sandpiper with high-pitched calls. A child, they are the youngest. Like Frailty, they enjoy pranking Reality.

CONDUCTOR is the literal music conductor of the production. They shape how time flows for the time travelers, based on their choice of instruments and musical phrases. Without them, every being (will) dies/died.

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MUSICAL NUMBERS

ACT I

1. Overture Eternity, Conductor
2. Prologue: The Seeds of Fate Timeharmonic Orchestra
3. Born in the Wrong Generation Tabitha, Dakota, Jesse, Jessica, Ancient People, Modern People
4. The Right Person Tabitha, Dakota
5. The Wrong Time Tabitha, Dakota, Timepipers
6. Era, Error, Eureka Tabitha, Dakota, Timeharmonic Orchestra
7. Out of Tune Eternity, Timeharmonic Orchestra
8. Father is Long Gone, Mother Ain't Born Yet Tabitha, Dakota
9. Must Be Nice (Times Like These) Tabitha, Dakota, Past People
10. Band Together Tabitha, Dakota, Past People
11. Until the Beginning Tabitha, Dakota, Timepipers, People
12. Future Plans Tabitha, Dakota, Timeharmonic Orchestra
13. The Wrong Time (Reprise) Tabitha, Dakota

ACT II

14. Passing By, Running Behind Tabitha, Jessica, Modern People
15. Keep Tabs (on Your Heart) Dakota, Jesse, Ancient People
16. The Songs Linger (Long Enough) Timeharmonic Orchestra
17. Life is Short (You Must Be This Old to Die) Tabitha, Dakota, Conductor
18. In Loving Destiny Tabitha, Dakota
19. Seconds Can't Count Tabitha, Dakota, Conductor, Ancient People, Modern People
20. Out of Wack Eternity, Conductor, Timeharmonic Orchestra, Tabitha, Dakota
21. Paradox Company
22. Right Person, Wrong Time Tabitha, Dakota
23. From the End Dakota, Jessica, Tabitha
24. In Loving Destiny (Reprise) Company

★One or two songs will be a David Quang Pham signature science song teaching paleoethnobotany and archaeology.

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PLOT SUMMARY

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SAMPLE SCENE

(Reality drags Frailty and Destiny in.)

REALITY: You two cannot be going around playing Cupid!!!

FRAILITY: Cupid won't knowth, DESTINY: They ain't gonna know,
they're on a journey. They've they're on vacay.
started something extraordinary. I ship Tab and Coda.

REALITY: We've got to get Tabitha and Dakota back in their timelines, or
it'll be our own pasts, presents, and futures on the line!

DESTINY: (acting cute) Eternity ain't gonna take it out on us...

FRAILITY: They will ensure the Conductor won't see tomorrow, or
yesterday, or today.

(The Conductor stops conducting.)

REALITY: Keep conducting! You heard nothing.

DESTINY: What happens if that happens?

REALITY: The timeline will be erased and Madam/Sir Eternity will take it to
the Higher Ups to reorchestrate history.

FRAILITY: Gone will be my trees and dolls...

REALITY: My toy boats and model trains...

DESTINY: My followers on TikTok...

(Frailty and Reality stare down Destiny.)

DESTINY: It's what I named my cuckoo clock...

REALITY: The Higher Ups will not make a Tyrannosaurus Rex the same way.

FRAILITY: They could do without the feathers this time.

DESTINY: Dead-tex. They had feathers?!!! So demure...

REALITY: You were on TikTok cuckoo clock when you shoulda paid attention.